

inflation and taxes. I'm an accountant, right? I went over and over the numbers. A net worth of \$400,000 or \$500,000 doesn't *seem* like enough. But pencils don't lie. I *knew* I didn't need any more money.

So the only reason to work was for nonfinancial rewards. Does that make any sense?

It can for some people.

A HARD-DRIVING SUCCESS WITH A SOUTHERN DRAWL

According to *Forbes* magazine, Sam Walton was the richest man in America in 1987. The article says he's 69 and has over \$8.5 billion of stock in Wal-Mart, the company he founded. Whatever he wants to buy, with \$8.5 billion he can buy a lot of it. He's so rich he could outspend a Saudi prince *before* OPEC lost its grip on the oil market. He can live wherever he wants, do whatever he wants, and spend whatever he wants.

So what does he want? More work, that's what. He works eighteen hours a day. He's a true role model for the American work ethic.

He lives in Bentonville, Arkansas, in a rustic ranch house that's comfortable but not spectacular. His passion, outside of Wal-Mart, is quail hunting, what else? At the beginning of the season he waits in line in the local Wal-Mart to buy shotgun shells. Then he heads off with his hunting dogs in his 1979 Ford pickup.

Associates say he's not much interested in what he's worth. He doesn't spend much on himself—probably \$50 a day, just like Vicki and I do.

If you asked Sam Walton why he works, he probably wouldn't talk of money. I'm guessing now, but he'd probably say he's having a ball at Wal-Mart. He'd say he still gets a kick out of socking it to the competition. He'd say he loves playing the game and the thrill of winning.